INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BEEF SWISS STEAK, WITH GRAVY, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This interim Federal specification was developed by the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers beef swiss steaks, with gravy, thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, and other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

FSC 8940

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specifications for

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Canned Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Institutional Meat Purchase Specification for Fresh Beef Series 100

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Livestock, Meat, Grain and Seed Division, 14th Street and Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250.)

United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Food Quality Assurance Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1, and 6.4).

3.2 Other ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent and insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Beef swiss steaks. The beef swiss steaks shall be formed IMPS No. 1102, USDA certified, and shall be approximately 6 ounces in weight and 0.5 inch in thickness.

3.2.2 Corn starch. Corn starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified waxy maize food starch for use in canned foods. The starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starchy taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.3 Worcestershire sauce. The sauce shall be a brown or dark brown colored liquid having a pleasant, tart, peppery, fruit-spice flavor and shall possess the body and character typical of this sauce. It shall have a titratable acidity (as acetic acid) of not less than 3.4 nor more than 3.6 percent.

3.2.4 Wheat flour. Flour shall be general purpose, white (bleached), free from mold and free from lumps that do not break under light finger pressure. The flour shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

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3.2.5 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agents.

3.2.6 Hydrolyzed vegetable protein (HVP). The hydrolyzed vegetable protein shall be obtained by the hydrolysis of any one or any combination of corn, soybean, or wheat proteins from which none of the monosodium glutamate has been extracted during processing and shall have a characteristic color and flavor. The salt-free solids shall be not less than 60 percent. The pH of a three percent solution shall not be less than 5.0 nor more than 6.3. Hydrolyzed protein shall be soluble in water at 90°F to the extent of not less than 5 grams in 100 milliliters.

3.2.7 Brown sugar. The sugar shall be partially refined cane sugar. It shall be light brown in color and shall have a sweet, molasses-like flavor.

3.2.8 Garlic powder. Garlic shall be dehydrated garlic powder that is pungent, free flowing, uniformly light in color, practically free from skin and scorched particles and free from husk, root base, stem, soil, and mold.

3.2.9 Celery seed. Ground celery seed shall be prepared from the seed of Apium graveolens L. The ground celery seed shall be light to rich brown in color and possess a characteristic celery odor and flavor with a warm slightly bitter after taste.

3.2.10 Onion. Onions shall be chopped, dehydrated, and practically free from such defects as outer skin, scorched material, outer root base, seed stems and harmless extraneous vegetable material. Onions shall be free flowing, pungent and shall have a bright uniform color.

3.2.11 Ground black pepper. Ground black pepper shall have a penetrating odor, a hot-biting-pungent flavor, a light grey to speckled black-grey color, and be free from adulterants. The volatile oil content shall be not less than 2.0 mL/100 g.

3.3 Beef steak preparation. The steaks shall be browned on a grill (continuous broiler, oven) or by an equivalent method to approximately a 75 percent yield. The browned steaks shall be cooled as rapidly as possible to a temperature of not less than 28°F nor more than 40°F and held in this temperature range for not more than 24 hours. Cooling of the beef is not necessary if filling of trays occurs immediately after browning.

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3.4 Gravy preparation. The gravy shall be prepared from the following ingredients:

Ingredients	Percent
Water	83.63
Onions, chopped, rehydrated	7.51
Corn starch	3.00
Worcestershire sauce	1.54
Flour	1.50
Salt	1.23
HVP	0.75
Brown sugar	0.40
Garlic powder	0.31
Celery seed, ground	0.10
Black pepper, ground	0.03
	100.00

The flour, starch and part of the water shall be mixed to form a slurry. The remaining ingredients shall be mixed together and heated to approximately 140°F. The starch slurry shall be added and the complete mixture heated to 180°F and held for approximately 5 minutes at this temperature. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted with water before tray filling to compensate for evaporation loss during heating. The gravy shall be placed in the tray pack cans within 4 hours after the heating at 180°F is completed. The temperature of the prepared gravy shall not be allowed to fall below 150°F at any time prior to filling into the cans.

3.5 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with 14 beef steaks (approximately 63 ounces) shingled in two rows and covered with gravy (approximately 43 ounces) such as to conform to the following requirements:

a. The temperature of the gravy at time of filling shall be not less than 150°F.

b. The can shall be jostled to allow the gravy to penetrate the spaces between the shingled steaks.

c. The average net weight shall be 106 ounces minimum.

d. No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces of product.

e. No individual can shall contain less than 44 ounces of washed and drained steaks.

f. The cans shall be hermetically sealed immediately after filling.

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3.6 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

3.7 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material, such as but not limited to dirt, insect, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.
b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor, such as but not limited to burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.
c. There shall be no foreign color, such as but not limited to black, purple, blue, yellow or white.
d. Steaks shall not be dry, tough, rubbery or mushy.
e. Most beef steaks shall be discernible as distinct steaks.
f. Total weight of opaque connective tissue, ligament, tendon, fat chunks, blood vessel, cartilage, or glandular material shall be not more than 1 ounce.
g. The gravy shall not be too thick, thin, or lumpy.
h. The average fat content of the finished product shall not exceed 7.5 percent.
i. The fat content of any individual tray pack shall not exceed 9.5 percent.
j. The salt content of any individual tray pack shall be not more than 1.25 percent.
k. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.8 Plant qualification. The meat component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.9 Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

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4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or other applicable purchase documents.

4.4.1 Ingredient examination. Conformance of ingredients to identity and condition requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, US Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient lot or of any involved product.

4.5 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, and sealing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.6 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.6.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.6.2 Product inspection. Eight tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot. The eight tray packs shall be heated at least 15 minutes in 140° to 150°F water, opened, and inspected in accordance with table I.

a. If no defects are found, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If two or more defects are found, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If only one defect is found, a second sample of eight tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot, heated as above, and inspected for the defects indicated in table I. If any defect is found in the second sample, the lot shall be rejected.

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TABLE I. Product inspection 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
151	Drained weight of steaks in a can is less than 44 ounces. 3/
152	Steaks not shingled in two rows.
153	Steaks dry, tough, rubbery, or mushy.
154	Steaks not discernible (less than 75 percent distinct steaks by weight). 4/
155	Total weight of fat chunks, opaque connective tissue, ligaments, tendons, blood vessels, cartilage or glandular material is more than 1 ounce.
156	Gravy too thick, thin, or lumpy.

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by the AMS agent).

3/ To determine drained weight in a can, the free liquid shall be poured off and the remaining contents shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 190° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated such as to liquify rendered fat and to remove gravy without breaking the steaks. The contents shall then be poured into a US Standard 1/4 inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the steaks. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted slightly and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. Drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce.

4/ Percentage should be based on drained weight.

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4.6.3 Fat and salt content testing. Nine tray pack cans shall be selected from the lot and distributed as follows:

- Three for laboratory analyses.
- Three for submission to contractor.
- Three for retention by the AMS agent as a reserve sample.

The three tray packs for laboratory analyses shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association for Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat, except that preparation of the sample shall be as follows. The three unopened tray packs shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. The average fat content of the three tray packs exceeds 7.5 percent.
b. The fat content in any individual tray pack exceeds 9.5 percent.
c. The salt content in any individual tray pack is more than 1.25 percent.

Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or salt content requirement. When the reserve samples are analyzed, the analyses for both fat and salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.8 Shipping container examination. When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in construction, closure and reinforcement shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) When applicable, reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used.

4.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

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5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 106 ounces of the food product, sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.6 and 3.7. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient weight and temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be full length and width less approximately 1/4 inch in each dimension. The box liner and pads shall be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.2.1 Nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. When specified (see 6.1 and 6.3), the shipping container specified in 5.2.2 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be full length and width less approximately 1/4 inch in each dimension and shall be fabricated of class domestic fiberboard.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. For distribution to the Navy and Air Force, when unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each package shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

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TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Remove from water and open lid for serving.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.
WARNING: Do not place closed can in oven as heating will cause the can to burst.

YIELD

Approximately 14 servings of one steak each.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.4).
(c) Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.7 and 6.4).
(d) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) When nonmetallic reinforcement is required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(f) Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 Selection of nonmetallic reinforcement. The nonmetallic reinforcement specified in 5.2.2.1 should be selected for shipping containers that are destined for transfer at sea or other specific overseas operations.

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6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection and approval of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-A402

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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